

Project Proposal

COURSE CODE: 299

GROUP NO: 02

SECTION:03

Serial No.	Student ID	Name
1.	2411707042	Zarifa Rahman
2.	2411131042	Tazrean Tasneem
3.	2412478042	Tahmidatul Ayesha Asha
4.	2413463042	Soumik Sikder
5.	2412599042	Tanzim Ahamad

SideQuest: A Social Chatting and Group Hangout Decision-Making Application

Abstract

Planning a group hangout often becomes difficult when several people have different preferences regarding activities, locations, food, budget, and time. In conventional messaging applications, suggestions are usually scattered across long conversations, making it difficult for a group to compare options and reach a final decision. **SideQuest** is a social chatting application designed to integrate communication with structured group hangout planning. The system allows users to communicate through private and group chats and initiate a dedicated **SideQuest** planning session within a group conversation. Group members can specify preferences, suggest possible activities or locations, vote on available options, and create either single-activity or multi-activity plans. Once a decision is reached, the application generates a final hangout plan containing the selected activities, locations, date, time, participants, and estimated budget. The main objective of SideQuest is to reduce the difficulty of group decision-making while keeping the planning process integrated within the friends' existing conversation.

Introduction

Messaging applications allow users to communicate easily with friends; however, arranging group activities through ordinary conversations can become inefficient. When friends attempt to organize a hangout, multiple suggestions regarding restaurants, cafés, movies, shopping, games, or other activities may appear throughout the conversation. Different members may also have different preferences regarding budget, location, time, or type of activity.

As the number of suggestions increases, reaching a final agreement can become difficult. SideQuest is proposed as a social chatting application that combines normal communication with a structured group planning system.

The core feature of the application is “**Start a SideQuest.**” Through this feature, members of a group chat can create a dedicated planning session and collectively decide what they want to do. Rather than allowing suggestions to remain scattered throughout the conversation, the system organizes the available options, preferences, and votes into a single planning process.

Problem Statement

Group hangout planning through conventional messaging applications is generally unstructured and time-consuming. Members may repeatedly suggest different activities or locations without having an effective method for comparing alternatives or identifying the preference of the majority.

Common discussions such as “*Where should we go?*”, “*What should we eat?*”, or “*What should we do?*” may continue for a long time without producing a clear decision.

Therefore, there is a need for a system that allows friends to communicate naturally while also providing an organized way to propose, compare, and select hangout options.

Proposed System

SideQuest will provide standard social communication features, including user accounts, friend management, private messaging, and group chats.

Within a group conversation, a member will be able to initiate a **SideQuest**. The group can then determine whether the planned hangout will contain a single activity or several activities arranged as part of a complete plan.

For example, a SideQuest may contain:

Lunch → Movie → Dessert

or

Bowling → Dinner → Café

Users will be able to specify basic planning preferences such as:

- Budget
- Activity type
- Cuisine
- Preferred location or distance
- Available time
- Indoor or outdoor preference

Possible options can then be added or presented within the SideQuest session. Group members will be able to vote for preferred choices, allowing the system to narrow the available alternatives and assist the group in reaching a final decision.

After the decision-making process is complete, the system will generate a **Final Hangout Plan** containing relevant information such as the date, time, activities, locations, estimated budget, and participating members.

System Objectives

The objectives of the proposed system are to:

1. Develop a social communication platform supporting private and group conversations.
2. Provide an integrated system for planning group hangouts.
3. Allow groups to create both single-activity and multi-activity plans.
4. Allow members to define basic preferences before selecting an activity.
5. Organize suggestions within a dedicated planning session.
6. provide a voting mechanism for collaborative decision-making.
7. Generate an organized final hangout plan after a decision is reached.
8. Maintain previous SideQuest plans for future reference.

Main System Features

The proposed application will contain the following core features:

- User registration/login and profiles
- Friend management
- Private messaging

- Group messaging
- Creation of SideQuest planning sessions
- Single or multiple activity selection
- Group preference selection
- Addition and presentation of hangout options
- Group voting
- Final hangout plan generation
- Previous SideQuest history

The system will also contain two small social games that can be accessed from group conversations.

A. Friend Trivia

One member provides answers to several questions about themselves. Other members attempt to predict those answers, and the application calculates scores based on correct responses.

B. Would You Rather

Members are presented with two options and individually select their preferred one. After everyone has responded, the application displays the percentage of members who selected each option.

These games are secondary features and do not form part of the primary planning system.

System Workflow

The main workflow of SideQuest can be represented as:

Group Chat → Start a SideQuest → Select Activity Type → Enter Group Preferences → Add/Receive Options → Group Voting → Final Decision → Generate Hangout Plan

This workflow allows ordinary conversation and structured planning to remain within the same application.

Scope

The scope of SideQuest will focus on social communication and collaborative hangout planning. The system will allow friends to communicate, specify planning preferences, compare possible activities, vote on available options, and generate an organized final plan.

SideQuest is not intended to function primarily as a restaurant-searching platform, social networking platform, or gaming application. Its primary purpose is to provide a **group chatting application with an integrated hangout decision-making system**.

Expected Outcome

The expected outcome is a functional application through which a group of friends can communicate and collaboratively organize a hangout without relying on lengthy and unstructured discussions.

The completed system should enable users to move from the initial discussion of a hangout to an agreed final plan using a single platform. By organizing preferences, suggestions, and voting within a SideQuest session, the application is expected to make group decision-making more structured and convenient.

Conclusion

SideQuest proposes a combination of social communication and collaborative planning within a single application. Its main contribution is the **Start a SideQuest** feature, which transforms informal discussions about a hangout into a structured decision-making process. By allowing users to collect preferences, compare alternatives, vote, and generate a final plan, SideQuest aims to simplify one of the most common difficulties faced by friend groups when arranging activities together.